

Daniel 2-7

Prophecy, A Weapon for Our Times

Text Structure:

ch. 2 Prophecy	ch. 3 Persecution	ch. 4 Fall of Babylon	ch. 5 Fall of Babylon	ch. 6 Persecution	ch. 7 Prophecy
A	B	C	C'	B'	A'

ch. 4—"Fall of Babylon": how can the fall of Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, be equated with the fall of Babylon? In the Hebrew mindset king and kingdom are interchangeable.

Daniel 7:17: These great **beasts**, which **are** four, are four **kings**, which shall arise out of the earth.

Daniel 7:23: Thus he said, The fourth **beast** shall **be** the fourth **kingdom** upon earth, which shall be diverse from all kingdoms, and shall devour the whole earth, and shall tread it down, and break it in pieces.

Daniel 2:37-39: ³⁷ Thou, O **king**, art a king of kings: for the God of heaven hath given thee a **kingdom**, power, and strength, and glory. ³⁸ And wheresoever the children of men dwell, the beasts of the field and the fowls of the heaven hath he given into thine hand, and hath made thee ruler over them all. Thou art this head of gold. ³⁹ And **after thee [his dynasty and kingdom] shall arise another kingdom** inferior to thee,...

Furthermore, the king is represented by a tree in his dream but a cut down tree also represented a kingdom elsewhere in the Bible, namely the Assyrian Empire.

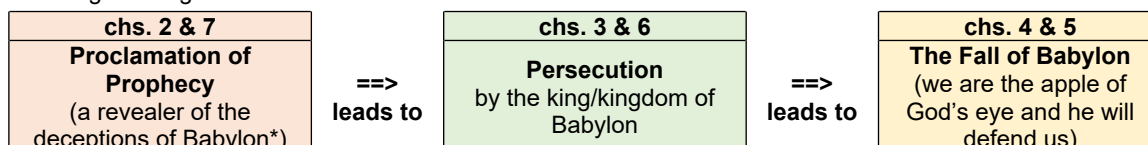
Ezekiel 31: ³ Behold, **the Assyrian was a cedar** in Lebanon with fair branches, and with a shadowing shroud, and of an high stature; and his top was among the thick boughs. ⁵ Therefore his height was exalted above all the trees of the field, and his boughs were multiplied, and his branches became long because of the multitude of waters, when he shot forth. ⁶ All the fowls of heaven made their nests in his boughs, and under his branches did all the beasts of the field bring forth their young, and under his shadow dwelt all great nations. ⁸ ... nor any tree in the garden of God was like unto him in his beauty. ⁹ I have made him fair by the multitude of his branches: so that all the trees of Eden, that were in the garden of God, envied him. ¹⁰ Therefore thus saith the Lord God; Because thou hast lifted up thyself in height, and he hath shot up his top among the thick boughs, and his heart is lifted up in his height; ¹¹ I have therefore delivered him into the hand of the mighty one of the heathen; he shall surely deal with him: I have driven him out for his wickedness. ¹² And strangers, **the terrible of the nations, have cut him off [cut him down]**, and have left him: upon the mountains and in all the valleys his branches are fallen, and his boughs are broken by all the rivers of the land; and all the people of the earth are gone down from his shadow, and have left him.

chs. 2-7—The Structure and its Message: the structure is indicated by the language and ordering of the chapters. In other words, we know that the structure was purposely designed through the use of language in the book and also by the arrangement of the chapters contrary to the natural chronological order.

ch. 1	ch. 2	ch. 3	ch. 4	ch. 5	ch. 6	ch. 7	ch. 8	ch. 9	ch. 10	ch. 11	ch. 12
Heb.	Aramaic						Hebrew				

ch. 2 2 nd year Nebuchadnezzar	ch. 3 Nebuchadnezzar rebels against ch. 2	ch. 4 Nebuchadnezzar is converted	ch. 5 Fall of Babylon to Persians under Belshazzar	ch. 6 Darius of the Medes and Persians	ch. 7 1 st year of Belshazzar
Babylon				Medo-Persia	Babylon
1	2	3	5	6	4

So the structure has been purposely highlighted by writing chapters 2 through 7 in Aramaic while the rest of the book is written in Hebrew. Also chapter 7 has been purposely moved out of chronological order since it should naturally appear between chapters 4 and 5. The result of these changes is our structure whose purpose is to convey the following message:



*Babylon or Babel means confusion or by implication, deception.

Genesis 11:9: Therefore is the name of it called Babel; because the Lord did there **confound** the language of all the earth: and from thence did the Lord scatter them abroad upon the face of all the earth.